

Poetry Analysis- 10 essential questions

1. Who is the speaker in this poem? What kind of person is he or she?
2. To whom is the speaker speaking, or in other words, who is the audience?
3. What are the situation and setting in time (era) and place?
4. What is the purpose of the poem?
5. State the poem's central idea or theme in a singular sentence.
6. Describe the structure of the poem. How does this relate to content?
7. What is the tone of the poem? How is it achieved?
8. Notice the poem's diction. Discuss any words which seem especially well-chosen.
9. Are there predominant usages of figurative language? What is the effect?
 - a. Metaphors
 - b. Similes
 - c. Imagery
 - d. Allusions
 - e. Personification
 - f. Symbols
10. Explain the use of any sound devices and whether or not they aid in conveying tone or theme.

Tone/Attitude Words

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| 1. accusatory-charging of wrong doing | 25. judgmental-authoritative and often having critical opinions |
| 2. apathetic-indifferent due to lack of energy or concern | 26. jovial-happy |
| 3. awe-solemn wonder | 27. lyrical-expressing a poet's inner feelings; emotional; full of images; song-like |
| 4. bitter-exhibiting strong animosity as a result of pain or grief | 28. matter-of-fact--accepting of conditions; not fanciful or emotional |
| 5. cynical-questions the basic sincerity and goodness of people | 29. mocking-treating with contempt or ridicule |
| 6. condescension; condescending-a feeling of superiority | 30. morose-gloomy, sullen, surly, despondent |
| 7. callous-unfeeling, insensitive to feelings of others | 31. malicious-purposely hurtful |
| 8. contemplative-studying, thinking, reflecting on an issue | 32. objective-an unbiased view-able to leave personal judgments aside |
| 9. critical-finding fault | 33. optimistic-hopeful, cheerful |
| 10. choleric-hot-tempered, easily angered | 34. obsequious-polite and obedient in order to gain something |
| 11. contemptuous-showing or feeling that something is worthless or lacks respect | 35. patronizing-air of condescension |
| 12. caustic-intense use of sarcasm; stinging, biting | 36. pessimistic-seeing the worst side of things; no hope |
| 13. conventional-lacking spontaneity, originality, and individuality | 37. quizzical-odd, eccentric, amusing |
| 14. disdainful-scornful | 38. ribald-offensive in speech or gesture |
| 15. didactic-author attempts to educate or instruct the reader | 39. reverent-treating a subject with honor and respect |
| 16. derisive-ridiculing, mocking | 40. ridiculing-slightly contemptuous banter; making fun of |
| 17. earnest-intense, a sincere state of mind | 41. reflective-illustrating innermost thoughts and emotions |
| 18. erudite-learned, polished, scholarly | 42. sarcastic-sneering, caustic |
| 19. fanciful-using the imagination | 43. sardonic-scornfully and bitterly sarcastic |
| 20. forthright-directly frank without hesitation | 44. satiric-ridiculing to show weakness in order to make a point, teach |
| 21. gloomy-darkness, sadness, rejection | 45. sincere-without deceit or pretense; genuine |
| 22. haughty-proud and vain to the point of arrogance | 46. solemn-deeply earnest, tending toward sad reflection |
| 23. indignant-marked by anger aroused by injustice | 47. sanguineous -optimistic, cheerful |
| 24. intimate-very familiar | 48. whimsical-odd, strange, fantastic; fun |

